



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

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For Further
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CHRISTMAS COMPUTERS:

PICKING THE BEST VALUE THIS SEASON

There's no need for panic this Christmas if a personal computer is at the top of someone's "wish list." The most popular and versatile computers can also be the best value -- if you know what to look for.

The key in selecting a computer as a gift is to know the real needs of the person receiving the computer. A sixth grader, interested in computer games and BASIC language programing, doesn't need the same system as the business executive who wants to bring spreadsheets home instead of working late on the office computers.

"When people know exactly what they want to do with a computer, it's much easier to select the right computer," explained John Roach, CEO and President of Tandy Corporation. "Back in 1977 when our first personal computer went on the market, a lot of buyers were just eager to have a computer in their homes...they weren't sure exactly what it could do for them, but they were awed by the technology that was suddenly available."

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CHRISTMAS COMPUTERS -- ADD ONE

"Today's consumers are asking more questions before they buy, and that's a positive thing. People should know what to expect before they bring their new computer home," Roach added.

Before you select a personal computer gift, try to find out what the computer will be used for, and select a system that offers those capabilities. "It's important to know that the computer you buy now will still be available next summer, and the year after that, and that the company will still be there to offer support and repairs," Roach cautions.

Gift buyers this season are likely to be looking for two distinct types of computers, according to Roach. A large market segment consists of parents who want a computer that will help their children become computer literate. It's important for parents to select a system that is expandable, so the computer can grow as the child's interests and knowledge grows. "You don't have to spend thousands of dollars to get a solid computer which will help your children learn by offering access to a wide range of educational software," Roach said.

The Color® Computer, sold at over 7,000 Radio Shack® Stores and Radio Shack Computer Centers nationwide, is one of the most popular home computers ever produced. A 16K Color Computer and a full 64K Color Computer with Extended BASIC are available at affordable prices. More than 150 software packages (ranging from word processors and

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CHRISTMAS COMPUTERS -- ADD TWO

"productivity" software like database management programs through popular games and learning programs) are available for the Color Computer. Add-on peripherals range from printers, modems and disk drives to a new music synthesizer called Orchestra-90 CC which turns the computer into a music-maker. Color Computers are used by more than 500 school systems around the country, so many kids find them the perfect adjunct to classroom learning.

"One of the nice things about buying an expandable system is that you determine how much you want to spend by picking those options you want," Roach added. "The Color Computer is easy to use and comes with everything you need to hook it up to the family TV set and plug in your first program. That's important for the family just getting into computing."

Families who want a multi-purpose machine are another large segment of the market. These buyers want a machine that runs all the most popular office software, so Mom and Dad can bring work home, but they want a system that also offers color graphics, ease-of-use and the ability to run educational software or games. "We created the Tandy® 1000 personal computer as an office machine, but now that it's the only MS-DOS® machine available for less than \$1,000, many families are choosing them for home use," Roach said.

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CHRISTMAS COMPUTERS -- ADD THREE

With full IBM® compatibility, the Tandy 1000 personal computer can run the widest possible range of software, and has many included features which are extra price options on more expensive computers. "We have a Tandy 1000 personal computer at my house, and about 8:30 every night there's a discussion about who's going to use the computer next -- my oldest daughter has a report to write, my younger daughter wants to do her paper, my wife wants to take care of some business, I've got work to do...and there are always new games and graphics programs to try out. We may just find another computer under our Christmas tree," Roach said.

"If Christmas will bring the first computer for your family, it's important to find out what kind of support is available. Radio Shack offers classes through over 400 locations nationwide. Free telephone support is another feature to look for when selecting the right model for your family. Buyers of Tandy computers can call any of 60 local Area Training and Support Organization hotlines in major cities around the country, or call national company headquarters if they can't get the help they need from their local store.

"Computers can be great tools. Kids can learn from them, and adults find them useful in many household and business tasks. The bottom line on whether or not to buy a computer for Christmas comes down to making sure you get the

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CHRISTMAS COMPUTERS -- ADD FOUR

most computer for your dollar, and that you're buying the right computer for your needs," Roach said.

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